SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

21 July 2022 · Shift 3

68 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 32 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 25 questions

Q.1

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. The young boy tried to jerk out of the way, / but she grabbed him and began / rubbing the tip of his nose to get the stain off.

(A) No error
(B) The young boy tried to jerk out of the way
(C) rubbing the tip of his nose to get the stain off
(D) but she grabbed him and began

Q.2

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Revile

(A) Silence
(B) Incite
(C) Discourage
(D) Abuse

Q.3

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. Stop "flogging a dead horse" and concentrate on your career.

(A) To waste time on useless things
(B) To go on trips repeatedly
(C) To fall in love quickly
(D) To make no progress

Q.4

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Autocrecy
(B) Bureaucracy
(C) Autonomy
(D) Anarchy

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. We need to _____ for next week, so are you in or out?

(A) make noise
(B) make a mess
(C) make plans
(D) make a mistake

Q.6

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. The plants "readily respond to these stimulus."

(A) readily respond to these stimuli
(B) ready respond to these stimuli
(C) readily responds to this stimulus
(D) No improvement required

Q.7

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Fright

(A) Dread
(B) Mockery
(C) Composure
(D) Bravery

Q.8

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them contains an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. We are all aware that our environment are not what it used to be.

(A) What it used to be
(B) We are all
(C) environment are not
(D) aware that our

Q.9

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Escapeade
(B) Resonate
(C) Progresion
(D) Disccovery

Q.10

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Most of the carbon-trapping mechanisms / that we have identified are / based at limit studies.

(A) No error
(B) that we have identified are
(C) based at limit studies
(D) Most of the carbon-trapping mechanisms

Q.11

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Incapable of making mistakes or being wrong

(A) Fatalist
(B) Fanatic
(C) Infallible
(D) Cynic

Q.12

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. Half a million dollars is only a "drop in the bucket" to what is required for this industry.

(A) An unreliable person
(B) unity and functioning together to achieve a goal
(C) A very small part of something big or whole
(D) a person or situation having no hope of positive change

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. This small hut is going to be my _____ for the next three days.

(A) legacy
(B) scout
(C) loaf
(D) abode

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. He believed that he had struck terror in his children's hearts because of his _____.

(A) love
(B) rage
(C) calmness
(D) fortune

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Miss Samantha is at the _____ of her popularity.

(A) pick
(B) peek
(C) peck
(D) peak

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Flexible

(A) Compliant
(B) Defiant
(C) Peculiar
(D) Reckless

Q.17

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. As the tree came crashing down, the monkeys “woke up from its sleep” and ran from branch to branch.

(A) woke up from their sleep
(B) No improvement required
(C) waken up in their sleep
(D) wakes up from its sleep

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The age of the participants _____ an important factor in this competition.

(A) is
(B) do
(C) has
(D) are

Q.19

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select ‘No improvement required’. “No other informations” was conveyed to him.

(A) No other’s information
(B) No improvement required
(C) No other information
(D) None another information

Q.20

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Someone working or acting merely for money or other rewards

(A) Debtor
(B) Mercenary
(C) Contractor
(D) Player

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Mahalia Jackson was (1) _____ into a preacher's family in 1911, and she grew up in a riverfront shanty in New Orleans. She was motherless at five, working as a maid and laundress in her mid-teens. As a little girl, she would (2) _____ to herself before she went to sleep, "Someday the sun is going to shine down on me in some faraway place." In pursuit of that dream, Mahalia migrated to Chicago when she was still a teenager. She never expected to support herself by singing, and by the time I joined her, the hands she used so expressively in her performances had (3) _____ floors, (4) _____ and helped her earn a living as a hotel maid, factory worker, beautician and florist. But her remarkable (5) _____ brought her more and more invitations to singat funerals, in churches, at concerts. And, through her warm friendly personality and a life based on sound spiritual values and hard work, she eventually found her place in the sun.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) Adorn
(B) Worn
(C) Born
(D) Scorn

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Mahalia Jackson was (1) _____ into a preacher's family in 1911, and she grew up in a riverfront shanty in New Orleans. She was motherless at five, working as a maid and laundress in her mid-teens. As a little girl, she would (2) _____ to herself before she went to sleep, "Someday the sun is going to shine down on me in some faraway place." In pursuit of that dream, Mahalia migrated to Chicago when she was still a teenager. She never expected to support herself by singing, and by the time I joined her, the hands she used so expressively in her performances had (3) _____ floors, (4) _____ and helped her earn a living as a hotel maid, factory worker, beautician and florist. But her remarkable (5) _____ brought her more and more invitations to singat funerals, in churches, at concerts. And, through her warm friendly personality and a life based on sound spiritual values and hard work, she eventually found her place in the sun.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) Whisper
(B) Glimmer
(C) Crisper
(D) Prosper

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Mahalia Jackson was (1) _____ into a preacher's family in 1911, and she grew up in a riverfront shanty in New Orleans. She was motherless at five, working as a maid and laundress in her mid-teens. As a little girl, she would (2) _____ to herself before she went to sleep, "Someday the sun is going to shine down on me in some faraway place." In pursuit of that dream, Mahalia migrated to Chicago when she was still a teenager. She never expected to support herself by singing, and by the time I joined her, the hands she used so expressively in her performances had (3) _____ floors, (4) _____ and helped her earn a living as a hotel maid, factory worker, beautician and florist. But her remarkable (5) _____ brought her more and more invitations to singat funerals, in churches, at concerts. And, through her warm friendly personality and a life based on sound spiritual values and hard work, she eventually found her place in the sun.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) Stubbed
(B) Clubbed
(C) Scrubbed
(D) Grubbed

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Mahalia Jackson was (1) _____ into a preacher's family in 1911, and she grew up in a riverfront shanty in New Orleans. She was motherless at five, working as a maid and laundress in her mid-teens. As a little girl, she would (2) _____ to herself before she went to sleep, "Someday the sun is going to shine down on me in some faraway place." In pursuit of that dream, Mahalia migrated to Chicago when she was still a teenager. She never expected to support herself by singing, and by the time I joined her, the hands she used so expressively in her performances had (3) _____ floors, (4) _____ and helped her earn a living as a hotel maid, factory worker, beautician and florist. But her remarkable (5) _____ brought her more and more invitations to singat funerals, in churches, at concerts. And, through her warm friendly personality and a life based on sound spiritual values and hard work, she eventually found her place in the sun.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) Pondered
(B) Laundered
(C) Unsoldered
(D) Considered

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Mahalia Jackson was (1) _____ into a preacher's family in 1911, and she grew up in a riverfront shanty in New Orleans. She was motherless at five, working as a maid and laundress in her mid-teens. As a little girl, she would (2) _____ to herself before she went to sleep, "Someday the sun is going to shine down on me in some faraway place." In pursuit of that dream, Mahalia migrated to Chicago when she was still a teenager. She never expected to support herself by singing, and by the time I joined her, the hands she used so expressively in her performances had (3) _____ floors, (4) _____ and helped her earn a living as a hotel maid, factory worker, beautician and florist. But her remarkable (5) _____ brought her more and more invitations to singat funerals, in churches, at concerts. And, through her warm friendly personality and a life based on sound spiritual values and hard work, she eventually found her place in the sun. Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) keeping-skills
(B) Voice
(C) Beauty
(D) Cleaning

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

In a certain code language, 'STOPER' is written as 'XNTJJL' and 'GANOPY' is written as 'LUSIUS'. How will 'FITAND' be written in that language?

(A) KDYUSX
(B) KCYUXS
(C) KCYUSX
(D) KCYVSX

Q.2

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 410, 210, 110, 60, 35, ?

(A) 23
(B) 25
(C) 20
(D) 22.5

Q.3

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. H64 : J100 :: L144 : N196 :: U441 : ?

(A) W582
(B) W529
(C) V484
(D) V221

Q.4

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. No R is a G. II. All G's are H. Conclusions: I. No H is a R. II. No G is a R.

(A) Only conclusion II follows.
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
(C) Both conclusions I and II follow.
(D) Only conclusion I follows.

Q.5

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 803, 844, 885, 926, ?

(A) 967
(B) 977
(C) 969
(D) 957

Q.6

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. RS : QT :: AK : ?

(A) IC
(B) HD
(C) HC
(D) ID

Q.7

In a certain code language, 'PINT' is coded as '60', and 'HOME' is coded as '42'. How will 'TONE' be coded in that language?

(A) 54
(B) 55
(C) 56
(D) 53

Q.8

By interchanging which two signs will the given equation be correct? 11 ÷ 77 + 253 × 23 – 800 = 58

(A) – and ÷
(B) × and ÷
(C) + and –
(D) – and ×

Q.10

Select the option in which the numbers shares the same relationship as that shared by the numbers in the given set. (32, 70, 108)

(A) (44, 82, 124)
(B) (34, 72, 112)
(C) (42, 80, 118)
(D) (38, 76, 116)

Q.11

Which two signs need to be interchanged to make the following equation correct? 96 – 12 ÷ 6 + 3 × 5 = 17

(A) ÷ and –
(B) ÷ and ×
(C) + and –
(D) + and ×

Q.12

In a certain code language, 'GERMAN' is written as 'HFSLZM', and 'RUSTIC' is written as 'SVTSHB'. How will 'DIVIDE' be written in that language?

(A) CHUJEF
(B) CHUHCD
(C) EJWJEF
(D) EJWHCD

Q.13

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first-letter cluster. CWIS : VBPF :: AOLD : ?

(A) CQUG
(B) CXJU
(C) XJMU
(D) EXUW

Q.15

Amit, Bablu, Ramesh, Deepak, Imran, Sunil, and Sanju are sitting around a circular table facing opposite to the centre. Amit does not sit adjacent to Imran and Sanju. Bablu does not sit adjacent to Amit. Sanju sits second to the left of Imran. Ramesh sits fourth to the left of Amit. Deepak and Bablu sit adjacent to each other. Who sits immediate right of Amit?

(A) Bablu
(B) Sunil
(C) Ramesh
(D) Sanju

Q.17

Study the given pattern carefully and select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in it. (7, 9, 130), (11, 9, ?), (16, 8, 320)

(A) 188
(B) 220
(C) 202
(D) 160

Q.18

In a certain code language, 'POM' is coded as '43', and 'HAN' is coded as '22'. How will 'BRO' be coded in that language?

(A) 36
(B) 33
(C) 35
(D) 34

Q.20

Five friends P, Q, R, S and T are sitting around a circular table facing towards the centre (not necessarily in the same order). Q is second to the left of T. S is the immediate neighbour of Q and T. R is not the immediate neighbour of Q. While counting from the left of Q, how many friends are sitting between Q and S?

(A) One
(B) Two
(C) Three
(D) Four

Q.21

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some holders are parameters. Some chambers are parameters. Some parameters are not measures. Conclusions: I. Some measures are chambers. II. Some holders are chambers.

(A) Only conclusion I follows
(B) Both conclusions I and II follow
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Neither conclusion I nor II follows

Q.23

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. BJT, DHV, FFX, ?, JBB

(A) HDY
(B) HCZ
(C) HDZ
(D) HCY

Q.25

Among five persons A, B, C, D and E, who are of different ages, A is younger than only D and E. E is younger than D and older than B. C is the youngest. Who is the fourth oldest?

(A) C
(B) D
(C) E
(D) B

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

Which of the following is an example of autotrophs?

(A) Protozoa
(B) Animals
(C) Viruses
(D) Green plants

Q.2

Which of the following terms is NOT associated with cricket?

(A) Maiden
(B) LBW
(C) Slam dunk
(D) Yorker

Q.3
Which of the following festivals marks the start of the Telugu New year?

(A) Onam
(B) Gudi Padwa
(C) Pongal
(D) Ugadi

Q.4
In which year did the Bhopal Gas Tragedy take place?

(A) 1986
(B) 1982
(C) 1984
(D) 1980

Q.5
Most Harappan seals made of _____.

(A) Bricks
(B) Granite
(C) Steatite
(D) Brass

Q.6
Who was the first Indian composer to win the Grammy Award?

(A) Zubin Mehta
(B) Zakir Hussain
(C) AR Rahman
(D) Pandit Ravi Shankar

Q.7
If a fundamental right of a citizen of India is violated, _____.

(A) he has to appeal in the Supreme court only
(B) he has to appeal in the district court first
(C) he has the choice of either approaching the Supreme court directly or the High court
(D) he has to appeal in the High court first

Q.9
Which of the following countries belong to the polar regions?

(A) Canada
(B) Colombia
(C) Chile
(D) China

Q.10
Kathak is a classical dance form of which Indian state?

(A) Tamil Nadu
(B) Uttar Pradesh
(C) Manipur
(D) Assam

Q.11
Mirabai Chanu won the first silver medal for India in weightlifting at the _____ Olympics 2020.

(A) Beijing
(B) Rio de Janeiro
(C) London
(D) Tokyo

Q.12
Which of the following measures of money supply is least liquid of all?

(A) M4
(B) M1
(C) M3
(D) M2

Q.13
Damon Galgut was awarded the Booker Prize 2021 for Fiction for his book _____.

(A) The Promise
(B) Great Circle
(C) A Passage North
(D) The Fortune Men

Q.14
The workforce population includes people between _____ years.

(A) 20 to 54
(B) 15 to 59
(C) 18 to 45
(D) 17 to 55

Q.15
Which of the following is a noble chemical element of the modern periodic table?

(A) Fluorine
(B) Silicon
(C) Nitrogen
(D) Neon

Q.16
Who among the following is popularly known as the ‘Disco King’ passed away in February 2022?

(A) Anupam Shyam
(B) Bappi Lahiri
(C) Vanraj Bhatia
(D) Chandrashekhar G

Q.17
Who among the following published the book ‘Stripurushtulna’?

(A) Anita Desai
(B) Tarabai Shinde
(C) Shashi Deshpande
(D) Pandita Ramabai

Q.18
Kanishka was a ruler of _____ dynasty.

(A) Mughal
(B) Maurya
(C) Kushana
(D) Gupta

Q.19
Who ruled over Delhi after Razia Sultan?

(A) Shamsuddin Iltutmish
(B) Ghiyasuddin Balban
(C) Prithviraj Chauhan
(D) Qutbuddin Aibak

Q.20
Which of the following campaigns was launched for greywater management in March 2022?

(A) Sujlam
(B) Sujlam 2.0
(C) Jalrakshak
(D) Jalrakshak 2.0

Q.21
As of April 2022, what is the official language of India's neighbouring country China?

(A) Bengali
(B) Burmese
(C) Sinhala
(D) Mandarin

Q.22
In which year through the Indian Official Secrets Act was freedom of press curbed?

(A) 1919
(B) 1921
(C) 1904
(D) 1909

Q.23
This layer of soil is dark in colour as it is rich in humus and minerals. It is generally soft, porous and can retain more water. It is called:

(A) B-horizon
(B) bedrock
(C) C-horizon
(D) topsoil

Q.24

Which of the following is NOT a function of the State Public Service Commission?

(A) It conducts examinations for appointments to the services of the state.

(B) It is consulted in all disciplinary matters affecting a person serving under the government of the state in a civil capacity.

(C) It is consulted on any claim for the award of a pension in respect of injuries sustained by a person while serving under the government of the state.

(D) It is consulted while making reservations of appointments or posts in favour of any backward class of citizens.

Q.25

Which of the following minerals are NOT found in Chota nagpur-belt?

(A) Gold

(B) Iron-ore

(C) Chromite

(D) Coal

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(C)**
Q.15 **(B)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(A)**
Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(B)**
Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(A)**

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (A) No error

The sentence is correct as it stands: 'tried to jerk out of the way', 'began rubbing' and 'to get the stain off' are all standard English.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Abuse

To 'revile' is to criticise someone in an abusive or angry way, so 'abuse' is the synonym. 'Incite' means to stir up and 'discourage' to put off.

Q.3 · Answer (A) To waste time on useless things

To 'flog a dead horse' is to waste effort on something that is already finished or has no chance of success.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Autocrecy

The correct spelling is 'autocracy', rule by one person with absolute power; it ends in '-cracy', as 'bureaucracy' does.

Q.5 · Answer (C) make plans

To 'make plans' is to arrange what to do, which is what 'are you in or out?' asks the listener to join.

Q.6 · Answer (A) readily respond to these stimuli

'These' is plural, so the noun must be the plural 'stimuli'; the adverb 'readily' and the plural verb 'respond' (agreeing with 'the plants') stay.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Dread

'Fright' is sudden fear, so 'dread', great fear, is the synonym. 'Composure' and 'bravery' are nearly opposite, and 'mockery' means ridicule.

Q.8 · Answer (C) environment are not

The subject 'our environment' is singular, so it takes 'is': 'our environment is not what it used to be'.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Resonate

'Resonate' is spelt correctly. The others should be 'escapade', 'progression' and 'discovery'.

Q.10 · Answer (C) based at limit studies

Mechanisms are 'based on' something, not 'at', and the noun 'studies' needs the adjective 'limited': 'based on limited studies'.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Infallible

'Infallible' means incapable of making mistakes. A fatalist believes everything is fated, a fanatic is excessively zealous and a cynic believes people act only from self-interest.

Q.12 · Answer (C) A very small part of something big or whole

A 'drop in the bucket' is an amount far too small to matter against what is needed.

Q.13 · Answer (D) abode

An 'abode' is a home or a place to live, which is what the hut will be. A legacy is something handed down, a scout someone sent ahead and a loaf a shaped mass of bread.

Q.14 · Answer (B) rage

His 'rage', violent anger, is what would strike terror into his children; 'love' and 'calmness' would not, and 'fortune' does not fit the sense.

Q.15 · Answer (D) peak

The 'peak' is the highest point. 'Peek', a quick look, sounds the same, and 'pick' and 'peck' do not fit.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Defiant

Of a person, 'flexible' means willing to change or give way, like 'compliant'; 'defiant', openly refusing to give way, is the nearest opposite. 'Peculiar' and 'reckless' are unrelated.

Q.17 · Answer (A) woke up from their sleep
'The monkeys' is plural, so the pronoun must be 'their': 'the monkeys woke up from their sleep'.

Q.18 · Answer (A) is
The subject is 'the age', which is singular, so the verb is 'is'; the phrase 'of the participants' does not change it.

Q.19 · Answer (C) No other information
'Information' is uncountable and has no plural form: 'No other information was conveyed to him.'

Q.20 · Answer (B) Mercenary
A mercenary works merely for money or reward, as a soldier hired by a foreign army does. A debtor owes money and a contractor agrees to do work under a contract.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Born
To be 'born into' a family is to be born a member of it: 'was born into a preacher's family in 1911'.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Whisper
The quoted words are something she said softly to herself before sleep: she would 'whisper' them. 'Glimmer' and 'prosper' do not describe speech, and 'crisper' is not a verb.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Scrubbed
Her hands had 'scrubbed' floors, cleaning them by rubbing hard, as she did working as a maid.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Laundered
She had worked as a laundress, so besides scrubbing floors her hands had 'laundered', that is washed and ironed clothes.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Voice
It was her remarkable singing 'voice' that brought her invitations to sing at funerals, in churches and at concerts.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (C) KCYUSX
The letters move 5 forward and 6 back in turn, wrapping round the alphabet: STOPER → XNTJJL and GANOPY → LUSIUS. So F → K, I → C, T → Y, A → U, N → S and D → X: KCYUSX.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 22.5
Each term is half the one before plus 5: 410 ÷ 2 + 5 = 210, 210 ÷ 2 + 5 = 110, 110 ÷ 2 + 5 = 60, 60 ÷ 2 + 5 = 35 and 35 ÷ 2 + 5 = 22.5.

Q.3 · Answer (B) W529
The number is the square of the letter's place in the alphabet, and the letter moves 2 places forward: H (8) 64 → J (10) 100 and L (12) 144 → N (14) 196. So U (21) 441 → W (23) 529.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Only conclusion II follows.
'No R is a G' converts to 'No G is a R', so II follows. The H that are not G may still be R, so I does not follow.

Q.5 · Answer (A) 967
Each term is 41 more than the one before: 803, 844, 885, 926, and 926 + 41 = 967.

Q.6 · Answer (A) IC
The two letters swap places, then the first moves 2 places back and the second 2 forward: RS → SR → QT. Likewise AK → KA → IC.

Q.7 · Answer (B) 55
The code is the sum of the letters' places in the alphabet plus 1: PINT = 16 + 9 + 14 + 20 + 1 = 60 and HOME = 8 + 15 + 13 + 5 + 1 = 42. So TONE = 20 + 15 + 14 + 5 + 1 = 55.

Q.8 · Answer (B) × and ÷
After interchanging × and ÷: 11 × 77 + 253 ÷ 23 − 800 = 847 + 11 − 800 = 58.

Q.10 · Answer (C) (42, 80, 118)
The numbers rise by 38 each time: 32 + 38 = 70 and 70 + 38 = 108. Likewise 42 + 38 = 80 and 80 + 38 = 118.

Q.11 · Answer (A) ÷ and –
After interchanging ÷ and –: 96 ÷ 12 – 6 + 3 × 5 = 8 – 6 + 15 = 17.

Q.12 · Answer (D) EJWHCD
The first three letters move 1 place forward and the last three 1 place back: GERMAN → HFS LZM and RUSTIC → SVT SHB. So DIVIDE → EJW HCD: EJWHCD.

Q.13 · Answer (C) XJMU
Each letter is replaced by its opposite (A ↔ Z, B ↔ Y and so on) and then moved 2 places back: C → X → V, W → D → B, I → R → P, S → H → F. So A → Z → X, O → L → J, L → O → M, D → W → U: XJMU.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Sunil
Facing away from the centre, each person's right is clockwise. The seats beside Amit can hold neither Imran, Sanju nor Bablu, so Deepak and Sunil take them, and with Ramesh fourth to Amit's left only one placing fits: clockwise from Amit, Amit, Sunil, Sanju, Ramesh, Imran, Bablu, Deepak. Sunil is on Amit's immediate right.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 202
The third number is the sum of the squares of the first two: $7^2 + 9^2 = 49 + 81 = 130$ and $16^2 + 8^2 = 256 + 64 = 320$. So $11^2 + 9^2 = 121 + 81 = 202$.

Q.18 · Answer (D) 34
The code is the sum of the letters' places in the alphabet minus 1: POM = 16 + 15 + 13 – 1 = 43 and HAN = 8 + 1 + 14 – 1 = 22. So BRO = 2 + 18 + 15 – 1 = 34.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Three
Facing the centre, each friend's left is clockwise. Q second to T's left with S between them, and R not beside Q, give clockwise from Q: Q, P, R, T, S. So three friends (P, R and T) sit between Q and S counting from Q's left.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
Holders and chambers are each linked only to some parameters, which may be different ones, so II does not follow; and 'some parameters are not measures' says nothing about chambers, so I does not follow either.

Q.23 · Answer (C) HDZ
The first letters move 2 forward (B, D, F, H, J), the second 2 back (J, H, F, D, B) and the third 2 forward, wrapping round after Z (T, V, X, Z, B): HDZ.

Q.25 · Answer (D) B
A is younger than only D and E, so A is third oldest, and D is older than E. B is younger than A and C is the youngest, so from the oldest the order is D, E, A, B, C: B is fourth.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Green plants
Green plants make their own food by photosynthesis, so they are autotrophs. Animals and most protozoa feed on other organisms, and viruses can multiply only inside living cells.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Slam dunk
A slam dunk is a basketball shot. A maiden (an over with no runs), LBW (leg before wicket) and a yorker are cricket terms.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Ugadi
Ugadi marks the New Year in Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Karnataka. Gudi Padwa is the Marathi New Year, while Onam (Kerala) and Pongal (Tamil Nadu) are harvest festivals.

Q.4 · Answer (C) 1984
The Bhopal gas tragedy happened on the night of 2-3 December 1984, when methyl isocyanate gas leaked from the Union Carbide pesticide plant in Bhopal.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Steatite
Most Harappan seals were carved from steatite, a soft stone, and usually bear an animal figure and a line of the Harappan script.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Pandit Ravi Shankar
Pandit Ravi Shankar won a Grammy in 1968 with Yehudi Menuhin for 'West Meets East', the first Indian to win one. Zakir Hussain's first came in 1992 ('Planet Drum') and A R Rahman's in 2010.

Q.7 · Answer (C) he has the choice of either approaching the Supreme court directly or the High court
Article 32 lets a person go straight to the Supreme Court to enforce a fundamental right, and Article 226 gives the High Courts the same power, so there is no need to approach a lower court first.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Canada
Northern Canada lies inside the Arctic Circle, in the north polar region. Colombia straddles the equator and China lies in the low and middle northern latitudes, while Chile's South American territory ends near 56° S, well short of the Antarctic Circle (its claim to part of Antarctica is frozen under the Antarctic Treaty).

Q.10 · Answer (B) Uttar Pradesh
Kathak is the classical dance of Uttar Pradesh, with its Lucknow gharana. Bharatanatyam belongs to Tamil Nadu, Manipuri to Manipur and Sattriya to Assam.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Tokyo
Mirabai Chanu won silver in the women's 49 kg weightlifting at the Tokyo Olympics, held in July 2021, India's first Olympic silver in the sport; Karnam Malleswari had won bronze at Sydney 2000.

Q.12 · Answer (A) M4
Liquidity falls from M1 to M4: M1 (currency with the public and demand deposits) is the most liquid, and M4, which adds all post office deposits to M3, the least.

Q.13 · Answer (A) The Promise
Damon Galgut won the 2021 Booker Prize for 'The Promise'. 'Great Circle' (Maggie Shipstead), 'A Passage North' (Anuk Arudpragasam) and 'The Fortune Men' (Nadifa Mohamed) were also on that year's shortlist.

Q.14 · Answer (B) 15 to 59
NCERT defines the workforce population as people from 15 to 59 years of age.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Neon
Neon is a noble gas, in group 18 of the periodic table. Fluorine is a halogen, nitrogen a group 15 non-metal and silicon a metalloid.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Bappi Lahiri
Bappi Lahiri, the composer and singer who brought disco music into Hindi films, died in Mumbai on 15 February 2022.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Tarabai Shinde
Tarabai Shinde published 'Stri Purush Tulana' (1882), a sharp comparison of how society treated women and men.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Kushana
Kanishka, the best-known Kushana king, ruled from Purushapura (Peshawar) and was a great patron of Buddhism.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Ghiyasuddin Balban
Balban is the only option who ruled after Razia Sultan (1236-1240), though not directly: Bahram Shah, Alauddin Masud and Nasiruddin Mahmud came between, and Balban took the throne in 1266. Iltutmish, her father, Qutbuddin Aibak and Prithviraj Chauhan all ruled before her.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Sujlam 2.0

The Ministry of Jal Shakti launched Sujlam 2.0, a campaign for greywater management, on World Water Day, 22 March 2022; the first Sujlam campaign began in August 2021.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Mandarin

China's official language is Mandarin (Standard Chinese). Bengali is the official language of Bangladesh and Burmese of Myanmar, while Sri Lanka's official languages are Sinhala and Tamil.

Q.22 · Answer (C) 1904

The Indian Official Secrets Act of 1904, passed under Lord Curzon, extended the 1889 law from military to civil matters and so restricted what the press could publish.

Q.23 · Answer (D) topsoil

The topsoil, or A-horizon, is the uppermost layer: dark with humus and minerals, soft, porous and able to hold more water. The B-horizon below has less humus, and the C-horizon is broken parent rock above the bedrock.

Q.24 · Answer (D) It is consulted while making reservations of appointments or posts in favour of any backward class of citizens.

Under Article 320(4) a Public Service Commission need not be consulted on reservations for backward classes made under Article 16(4). Conducting examinations, disciplinary matters and pension claims for injuries are among its functions under Article 320(1) and (3).

Q.25 · Answer (A) Gold

SSC's key gives gold. Coal (Jharia, Bokaro) and iron ore (Noamundi) are the Chota Nagpur belt's chief minerals and chromite occurs in West Singhbhum, while India's gold has come mainly from Karnataka's Kolar and Hutti fields, though the belt does have small gold deposits, such as the mine at Kundarkocha in East Singhbhum.

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